

Berserk Over Ram

There is nothing original in Tamil Nadu Chief Minister M. Karunanidhi's obnoxious verbal assault on Lord Ram ("In Ram's Name", October 1). People still remember Periyar, one of his ilk, for boldly denouncing the Hindu faith, without uttering a single word against Islam or Christianity. Karunanidhi is caught in a time warp and is still living in the 1950s when Ram-bashing was a rage among the "rationalists" of the state.

J. AKSHOBHYA, Mysore

False Hopes

It is not unusual to hear politicians making strange promises in this country ("Politics of Inclusive Growth", October 1). But it is strange that even after 35 years of *Garibi Hatao*, Finance Minister P. Chidambaram still harbours hope of seeing the back of poverty in his life time. The country must learn to live in reality.

K.K. MOHANTY, on e-mail

An Affair to Remember

Dev Anand's contribution to Indian cinema remains unparalleled ("One Life, Many Ladies", October 1). He has proved that age cannot be a hindrance to creative thinking and versatility.

MAHESH KAPASI, on e-mail

One could not understand the reason why a magazine like INDIA TODAY carried a five-page article on Dev Anand and his many leading ladies. Though a great actor, he stands nowhere near legends

like Raj Kapoor and Amitabh Bachchan.

T.S. PATTABHI RAMAN, Coimbatore

Not the Best

Though Goa has been adjudged the best amongst the small states, its health-care sector is in doldrums ("Leaders Lead, Laggards Lag", September 24). Many hospitals here are in a state of neglect and not even basic medical facilities have been made available.

AIRES RODRIGUES, on e-mail

Miffed Old Man

At 76, despite being a "serious traveller", V.S. Naipaul's pet peeve remains India, against whom he has said enough ("Home Truths", September 10). His rants against Nirad C. Choudhry and Mahatma Gandhi are pathetic. Sir Vidia needs to revisit history and he must learn to live in the shadow of the more illustrious Indians.

DEEPMALA GHOSH, Kolkata

LEFT, RIGHT, CENTRE



SIPRA DAS

Marxists do not believe in nationalism and economic progress is an anathema to their brand of development ("The Karat Dogma", September 17). They have done nothing for West Bengal even after 27 years of rule. An anti-imperialist and anti-American posture is a front for them to disguise their desperation for survival. They can only stay alive in an environment of poverty and by shedding crocodile tears for the poor.

P.B. MENON, Mumbai

No amount of linguistic superiority can hide the magazine's jaundiced view on the Left and their stand on the controversial Indo-US nuclear deal. The magazine has arrogated to itself the role of the final arbiter of national interest and denounced the Communist parties unabashedly even as the experts remain divided on the issue. We need a desperate break from this Left phobia.

PRAKASH PATIL, on e-mail

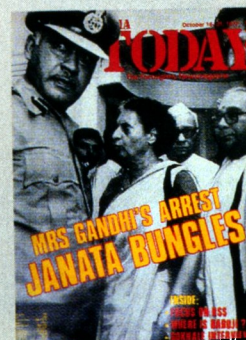
Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquiries before sending money, incurring expenses or entering into commitments in relation to any advertisement appearing in this publication. The India Today Group does not vouch for any claims made by the advertisers of products and services. The printer, publisher, editor-in-chief and the editor of the India Today Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences in the event of such claims not being honoured by the advertisers.

e-mail your letters to: letters.editor@intoday.com
or fax them to: 011-23316180

30

Years Ago in India Today

OCTOBER 16-31, 1977



Road to Rapprochement

Kashmir Chief Minister Sheikh Abdullah seems determined not to allow the Janata Party find a foothold in the state, while ensuring that the Centre is kept in good humour. The "Lion of Kashmir", whose distrust of the Janata Party stems from the RSS influence in its inner councils,

attempted to balance any counter-move by the Centre by playing



host to Mrs **Abdullah** Indira Gandhi during her visit to the state. The coming together of the two leaders, both of whom are hostile to the Janata Party, was viewed as an arrangement of convenience for both. For Mrs Gandhi, left alone after her electoral defeat, the support of a leader of Sheikh's stature would be invaluable in her comeback efforts. For the Sheikh, the support of an all-India party like the Congress would help his efforts to give Kashmir its pre-1953 status and revise some of the Central laws extended after 1953.

—G.N. Khayal

FOR SUBSCRIPTION ASSISTANCE CALL: (95120) 2479900 from DELHI and FARIDABAD; (0120) 2479900 from REST OF INDIA; Fax (0120) 4078080 KOLKATA: Tel 22821922, 22827726, 22825398 Fax 22825398, 22827254 BANGALORE: Tel 2212448, 2290562, 2218343 Fax 2218335 MUMBAI: Tel 24444423/4/5/6 Fax 24444358 CHENNAI: Tel 28478525-44 Fax 28472178. FOR CUSTOMER CARE CALL: 1800 1800 100 (from BSNL/MTNL lines) 120 2479900 (Monday-Friday, 10am-6 pm); WRITE IN: WE CARE, The India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (U.P.)-201301. e-mail: wecare@intoday.com